

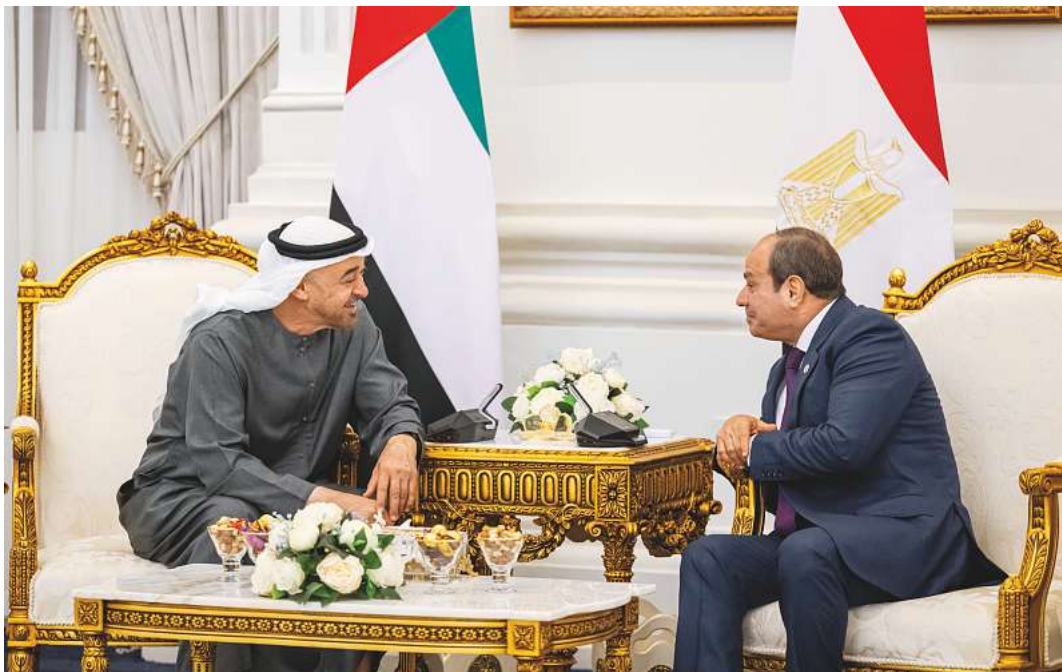
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MOHAMMAD MEETS AL SISSI IN EGYPT

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan was received upon his arrival at El Alamein International Airport by Egyptian President Abdul Fattah Al Sissi, during his fraternal visit to Egypt late on Monday. The two leaders engaged in cordial conversation, underscoring the deep-rooted and historical relations between the two countries.

WAM

India braces for harshest-ever US tariffs beginning today

Notification from US Homeland Security confirms new duties

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Indian exporters are bracing for a major trade shock as the US begins enforcing tariffs of up to 50 per cent on Indian goods from today, barring a last-minute reversal from President Donald Trump.

A US Homeland Security notification confirmed the new duties, which take effect from 9:31am IST today. The move doubles the 25 per cent tariff already in place, leaving India facing one of the toughest trade regimes imposed by Washington in years.

Exports, jobs, growth at risk

The US is India's largest export market, with shipments worth \$87 billion in 2024. Ana-

\$87 billion
worth of shipments
India exported to
US in 2024

lysts warn the tariffs will hamper labour-intensive sectors such as textiles, gems and jewellery, shrimp, leather, and apparel, though pharmaceuticals and electronics remain exempt.

Analysts at Nomura warn that 50 per cent duties would be "akin to a trade embargo", devastating profitability of smaller firms. The Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI) estimates two-thirds of India's exports to the US — worth \$60 billion — will face prohibitive duties, with shipments in affected sectors possibly plunging 70 per cent. That could trigger job losses and weaken India's position in supply chains.

Exporters already report cancelled orders and demand shifting to Vietnam and Bangladesh. Mithileshwar Thakur of the Apparel Export Promotion Council said Indian apparel is being priced out of the US market, facing a 30 per cent plus tariff gap versus competitors.

Economists warn growth could fall below 6 per cent this fiscal year — the weakest since the pandemic. Capital Economics projects a 0.8 percentage point hit this year and next.

Oil at heart of dispute

Washington has linked the tariffs to India's surging Russian oil imports, which US officials argue help Moscow finance its war effort. India rejects that view. New Delhi is preparing a \$2.8 billion support package, subsidies, and export diversification to 50 markets. But industry groups warn US demand cannot easily be replaced.

— with inputs from Agencies

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Population of Dubai up 3.5%, to hit 4 million

CITY HAS ADDED MORE THAN 200,000 PEOPLE IN THE LAST TWELVE MONTHS

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dubai's population is on the brink of crossing the four-million mark, according to new data from the Dubai Statistics Centre.

The population stood at 3,999,247 as of Monday, an increase of 3.5 per cent, or more than 134,000 people, since the start of the year. That pace translates into a daily rise of roughly 567 new residents, pushing Dubai to record levels.

Just a year ago, the emirate counted 3.79 million inhabitants, meaning the city has added more than 200,000 people in twelve months, the fastest clip in its history.

The surge is not confined to expatriates. Emirati citizens themselves grew by 2.5 per cent in 2024, reaching nearly 300,000. It is the highest number on record for the local population, reflecting steady natural growth alongside immigration.

175,000 people 50 years ago

Fifty years ago, Dubai was a small trading town of 175,000. The city hit the two-million threshold on Christmas Eve 2011, in the aftermath of the global financial crisis. To have doubled again in less than 15 years speaks to both the scale and velocity of the transformation.

Much of the momentum has come since the pandemic, when

2.5%
growth in Emirati
citizens last year,
now at 300,000

Dubai's open-door policy and reputation as a safe haven drew high-net-worth individuals from Britain, India, Russia, South-East Asia and Africa. Analysts estimate more than 30,000 Britons relocated to Dubai in each of the past three years, while waves of Russians and Ukrainians arrived following Moscow's invasion of Ukraine in 2022.

A report by New World Wealth for Henley & Partners this spring found that the number of millionaires in Dubai has doubled in a decade, cementing the emirate as one of the fastest-growing wealth hubs worldwide.

That influx of residents is visible in the city's daily life. Public transport journeys have more than doubled since 2010, topping 747 million last year. The city's tourism and hospitality sector is also surging. International arrivals in the first four months of 2025 reached 7.15 million, up 7 per cent from a year earlier. Hotels reported record occupancy of 83.5 per cent, with room rates and revenue per room both climbing. Dubai Mall alone now welcomes over 80 million visitors annually, more than New York City.



ENTERTAINMENT
Why Sourav Ganguly still rules hearts in his native West Bengal
Prince of Kolkata rivals biggest movie stars | P15

Siblings use horsepower for return to Al Ain school

Brother, sister ride horse-drawn carriage

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

A brother and sister in Al Ain began their school year in unusual style this week, riding a horse-drawn carriage through the streets to mark the first day of classes.

The charming gesture, blending tradition and fun, aimed to inspire excitement and energy for the academic year ahead.

The siblings sat side by side as the carriage made its way through the streets, drawing smiles from neighbours and passers-by. The scene, blending tradition with



a touch of whimsy, was part of a family initiative to motivate the children for a school year filled with energy and optimism.

What might have been an ordinary Monday morning became a small spectacle, reminding students that education is not just about lessons and exams, but also about creating experiences that inspire children to look forward to learning.



Watch:
Unique ride
to school

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